

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET D — ASSERTION & REASONING SPECIAL****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY****TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-D-06****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET D - Assertion & Reasoning Special):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Assertion-Reasoning Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Each question consists of two statements — **Assertion (A)** and **Reason (R)**.
3. Select the correct option from the following 4 standardized choices:
 - **(A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(C)** Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 - **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.
4. **Section A (Q1 – Q10):** Core Concepts & Theoretical Principles.
5. **Section B (Q11 – Q18):** Evidentiary Proofs, Case Inferences & Historical/Geographical Mechanisms.
6. **Section C (Q19 – Q25):** Advanced Conceptual Nuances & Institutional/Analytical Complexities.
7. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
8. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

STANDARD DIRECTIONS FOR ALL 25 ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS:

- (A)** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
(D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION A: CORE THEORETICAL PRINCIPLES (Q.1 TO Q.10) [10 MARKS]**Q.1****Assertion (A):** Democracy is a form of government in which rulers are elected by the citizens.**Reason (R):** The essential core principle of democracy is that political sovereignty resides with the people through competitive popular elections.

- (A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.2

Assertion (A): A country that merely conducts periodic elections cannot automatically be classified as a genuine democracy.

Reason (R): For elections to be democratic, they must offer a genuine choice between competing political alternatives with a fair chance for the ruling party to lose.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.3

Assertion (A): In Pakistan under General Pervez Musharraf, the 2002 Legal Framework Order made Pakistan a complete constitutional democracy.

Reason (R): The Legal Framework Order empowered the military President to dismiss national and provincial assemblies and subjected elected ministers to the National Security Council.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.4

Assertion (A): Democracy requires the principle of 'one person, one vote, one value'.

Reason (R): Equal political franchise ensures that every citizen possesses equal weight and equal moral worth in electing representative lawgivers.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.5

Assertion (A): In Fiji's electoral system prior to recent reforms, the vote of an indigenous Fijian had higher electoral value than that of an Indo-Fijian.

Reason (R): Democratic equality was fully respected because all citizens were permitted to cast their ballots on election day.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.6

Assertion (A): In China, elections are held regularly every five years for the National People's Congress.

Reason (R): China is a vibrant multi-party democracy where opposition candidates easily challenge and defeat Communist Party leaders.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.7

Assertion (A): A democratic government rules without any legal constraints or constitutional limitations.

Reason (R): A democratic government must function within constitutional laws passed by the legislature and respect citizen rights protected by an independent judiciary.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.8

Assertion (A): In Mexico, between 1930 and 2000, the Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) won every presidential election.

Reason (R): The PRI utilized state resources, coerced public employees, pressured media outlets, and shifted polling booths to prevent free and fair competition.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.9

Assertion (A): Democracy improves the quality of decision-making compared to autocracy.

Reason (R): Democratic processes involve multi-stakeholder consultations, open legislative debates, and parliamentary committees, reducing the risk of rash, arbitrary policies.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.10

Assertion (A): In an autocratic dictatorship, decisions are made faster than in a democratic assembly.

Reason (R): Dictators do not have to deliberate with elected parliaments or negotiate consensus among diverse societal groups.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION B: EVIDENTIARY PROOFS & MECHANISMS (Q.11 TO Q.18) [8 MARKS]**Q.11**

Assertion (A): Democracy provides an institutionalized mechanism to resolve conflicts among diverse social groups peacefully.

Reason (R): In a pluralistic society with differing regional, linguistic, and religious identities, democratic negotiations allow power-sharing without violent repression.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.12

Assertion (A): Critics argue that democracy leads to frequent political instability.

Reason (R): Electoral competition, shifting party coalitions, and regular changes in leadership can interrupt long-term policy continuity.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.13

Assertion (A): Democracy guarantees that governments will never commit mistakes or implement flawed economic policies.

Reason (R): Democracy provides open public forums to debate policy errors and guarantees citizens the electoral mechanism to replace governments that perform poorly.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.14

Assertion (A): The Great Chinese Famine of 1958–1961 resulted in nearly 30 million deaths, whereas democratic India did not experience famine of such scale.

Reason (R): Economist Amartya Sen observed that democratic governments with free press and opposition parties cannot afford to ignore famines without facing electoral defeat.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.15

Assertion (A): Democracy enhances the dignity of citizens regardless of their socioeconomic status.

Reason (R): In a democracy, the poorest and most marginalized citizens enjoy the exact same constitutional status and voting power as the wealthiest aristocrat.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.16

Assertion (A): In Zimbabwe, Robert Mugabe's ZANU-PF government respected media independence and welcomed peaceful protests.

Reason (R): Mugabe's regime harassed opposition workers, censored independent radio and newspapers, amended the constitution repeatedly, and used state violence to stay in power.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.17

Assertion (A): Direct democracy is universally practiced in all large modern nation-states like India and the United States.

Reason (R): Massive modern populations across vast continental territories make it physically impossible for all citizens to sit together and decide every executive matter daily.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.18

Assertion (A): The Swiss cantons provide one of the few surviving modern examples of direct democracy through referendums and citizen assemblies.

Reason (R): Switzerland allows citizens to propose constitutional initiatives and overturn legislative laws via mandatory popular referendums.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION C: ADVANCED NUANCES & INSTITUTIONAL COMPLEXITIES (Q.19 TO Q.25) [7 MARKS]**Q.19**

Assertion (A): A democratic decision involves consultation with and consent of all those who are affected by that decision.

Reason (R): The democratic principle applies not only to state governments but also to decision-making within families, schools, classrooms, and workplaces.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.20

Assertion (A): In a true democracy, majority rule gives the majority group the absolute right to strip minorities of their basic civil rights.

Reason (R): Constitutional democracy safeguards fundamental human rights and minority protections against the 'tyranny of the majority'.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.21

Assertion (A): Dr. B. R. Ambedkar warned against hero-worship (Bhakti) in political life during his final address to the Constituent Assembly.

Reason (R): Ambedkar argued that hero-worship in politics is a sure road to degradation and eventual dictatorship.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.22

Assertion (A): The presence of an independent judiciary is unnecessary for maintaining a healthy democratic system.

Reason (R): An independent judiciary acts as the guardian of the constitution, checks executive overreach, and protects citizen rights from legislative infringements.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.23

Assertion (A): Estonia's citizenship rules made it difficult for people belonging to the Russian ethnic minority to acquire voting rights.

Reason (R): Democratic equality requires that minority language communities be automatically denied civic franchise in all democratic states.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.24

Assertion (A): Democracy is not a magical cure-all that automatically solves poverty, unemployment, and all social evils.

Reason (R): Democracy creates a political framework where citizens and elected leaders possess the freedom to deliberate, organize, and demand socioeconomic reforms.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.25

Assertion (A): In India, Article 32 of the Constitution was referred to by Dr. Ambedkar as the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution.

Reason (R): Article 32 guarantees the Right to Constitutional Remedies, empowering citizens to move the Supreme Court directly to enforce their Fundamental Rights.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET D)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & HISTORICAL/GEOGRAPHICAL CAUSAL EXPLANATIONS (SET D)

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and correctly articulates the fundamental conceptual core of representative democracy.
Q.2	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains why procedural election ceremonies in authoritarian states do not equate to democratic governance.
Q.3	(D)	Assertion is false: The order consolidated military dictatorship and undermined democracy. Reason is true: Musharraf subordinated civilian governance to the military council.
Q.4	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the egalitarian philosophical rationale of universal equal franchise.
Q.5	(C)	Assertion is true: Fiji had unequal racial weighting of votes. Reason is false: Unequal vote value violates the democratic canon of 'one person, one value'.
Q.6	(C)	Assertion is true: China holds regular five-year NPC elections. Reason is false: All candidates must be approved by the Chinese Communist Party; opposition is prohibited.
Q.7	(D)	Assertion is false: Democracy is bounded by constitutional rule of law and human rights. Reason is true: Constitutional checks prevent executive tyranny.
Q.8	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and details how unfair electoral malpractice produced non-democratic single-party rule in Mexico.
Q.9	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the deliberative advantage of democratic institutional governance.
Q.10	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains why authoritarian speed comes at the sacrifice of consultative legitimacy and error correction.
Q.11	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains how democratic processes mitigate civil strife through accommodation.
Q.12	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and accurately reflects one of the primary analytical critiques leveled against democratic systems.
Q.13	(D)	Assertion is false: No political system is immune to mistakes. Reason is true: The unique strength of democracy is self-correction through public scrutiny.
Q.14	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides Sen's seminal theory on democratic accountability in preventing famine.
Q.15	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and highlights the moral and egalitarian foundation of democratic citizenship.
Q.16	(D)	Assertion is false: Mugabe severely curtailed democratic freedoms and persecuted opponents. Reason is true: State apparatus was weaponized against dissidents.
Q.17	(D)	Assertion is false: Large modern nations use representative democracy, not direct democracy. Reason is true: Demographic and logistical scale necessitates representative institutions.
Q.18	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the constitutional mechanism of direct democratic instruments in Switzerland.
Q.19	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and illustrates the broader societal culture and ethos of democratic participation.
Q.20	(D)	Assertion is false: Majority rule must operate within constitutional minority protections. Reason is true: Constitutionalism limits majoritarian tyranny.

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.21	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and captures Ambedkar's famous constitutional warning on the dangers of political personality cults.
Q.22	(D)	Assertion is false: An independent judiciary is indispensable in a democracy. Reason is true: Judicial review enforces constitutional boundaries.
Q.23	(C)	Assertion is true: Estonia's language laws hindered Russian minority citizenship. Reason is false: Denying minorities the vote violates democratic norms.
Q.24	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides a balanced realistic appraisal of what political democracy accomplishes.
Q.25	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains why the judicial enforcement of rights gives operational meaning to democratic freedom.